How might we...

improve how people save?

For students and early-career earners, 18–30, who save whatever is left over

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Two ideas. One product.

We merged our two strongest ideas into one product.

Gamified Savings

The spark to keep going

- Streaks and levels
- Daily challenges
- XP, badges, rewards
- Visual progress

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Community Capital

Save together, go together

- Shared squad goals
- Chip in anytime
- Friends see the bar move
- Squad votes on withdrawals

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SaveSquad

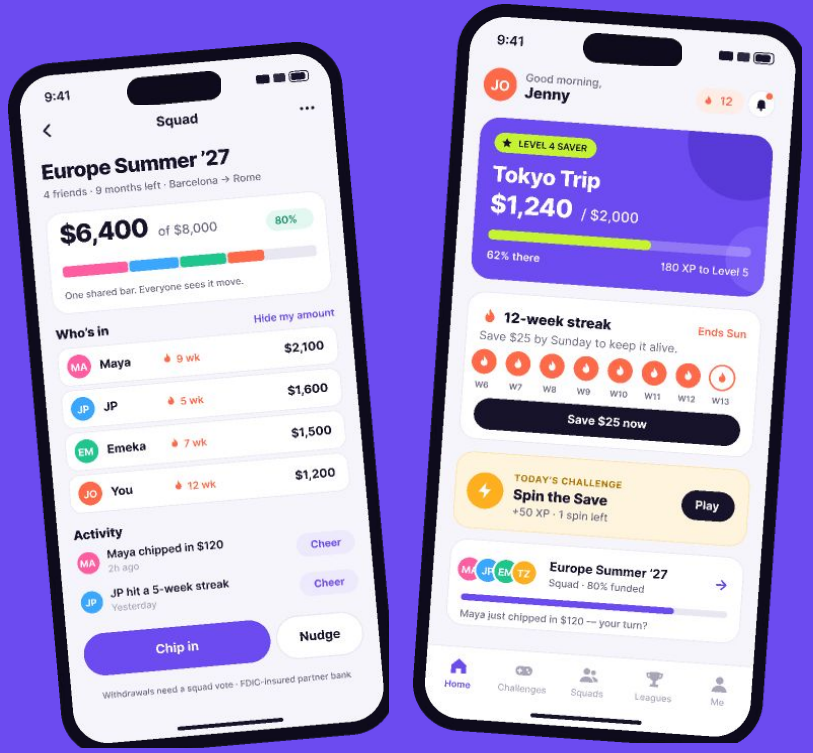
Your streak fuels your squad's goal.

SaveSquad

Save solo. Win together.

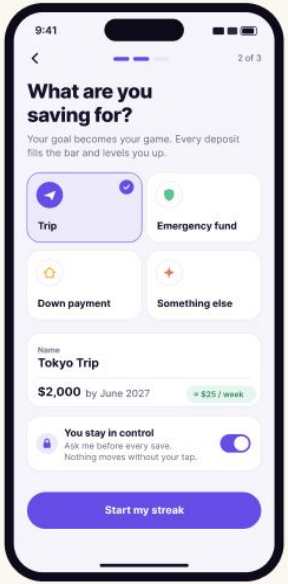
One app that combines gamified savings with community capital: your streaks and challenges power your squad's shared goals.

- **Streaks, levels and daily challenges**
- **Shared squad goals with friends**
- **Leagues ranked by consistency**



One loop: your progress powers your squad

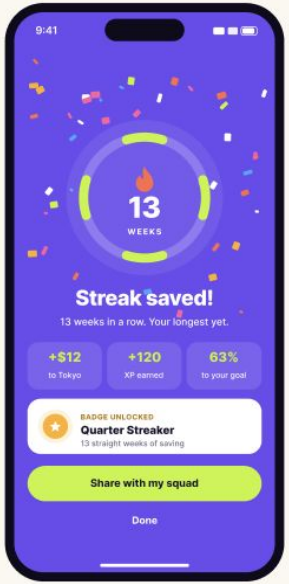
1 Pick a goal
It becomes your level.



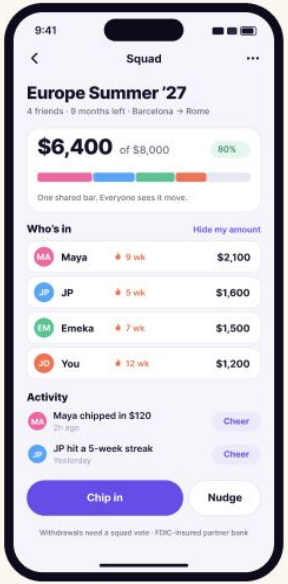
2 Play a challenge
Spin to see what you save.

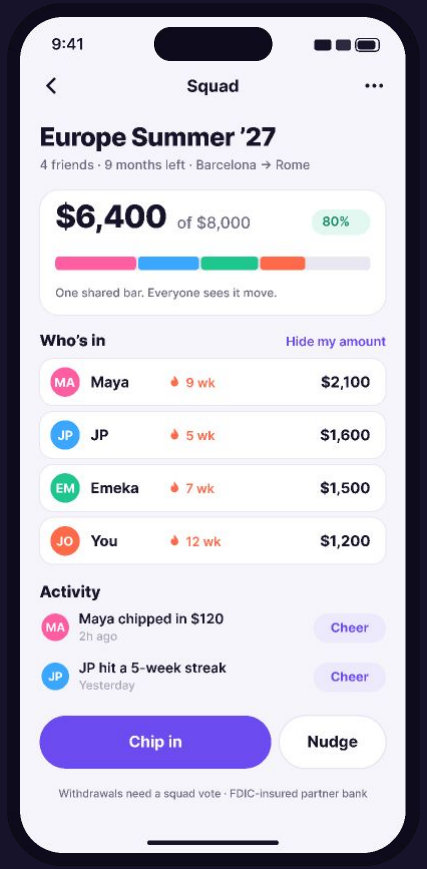


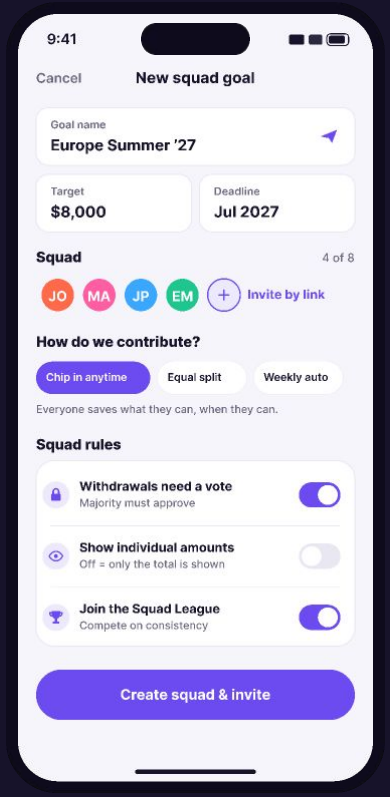
3 Get the win
Streak, XP and badges.



4 Rally the squad
Your win moves the shared bar.







COMMUNITY CAPITAL, BUILT IN

Better together

Save together for the things you'll do together.

- **One shared progress bar**
- **Chip in anytime, any amount**
- **Friends see the bar move**
- **Withdrawals need a squad vote**

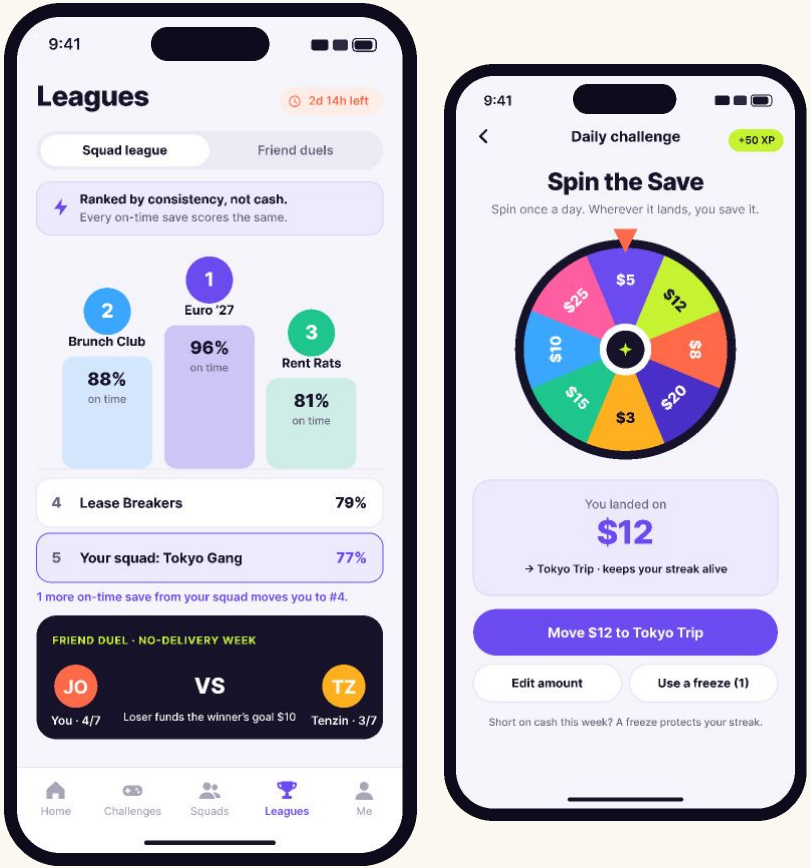
From an interviewee: it gets plans "out of the group chat."

Source: Team 317 interviews (n=20, Sept 2026)

Compete on consistency, not cash.

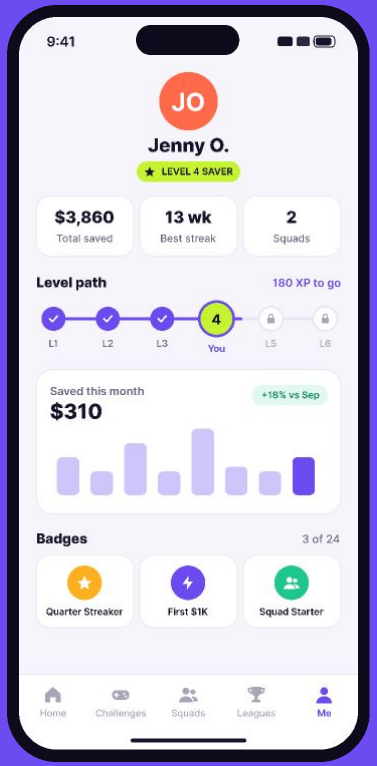
Income is the ceiling for most people we interviewed, so squads score on on-time saves, not dollars.

- **Weekly squad leagues**
- **1-on-1 friend duels**
- **Streak freezes for tight weeks**



Source: Team 317 interviews (n=20, Sept 2026)





The spark to keep going

Every save gets feedback, so it feels like progress.

- Streak saved moment
- XP, levels and badges
- Share the win with your squad
- Monthly progress you can see

Will they buy?

1. A shared goal with friends

Today's option: save leftovers alone, with no target.

→ 7 of 20 save leftovers or have no set goal.

2. Progress you can see

A bank balance gives no feedback and no deadline.

→ 7 of 20 asked for visual progress or simplicity.

3. What it costs them

A minute a week, trust in a new app, maybe a fee.

→ We keep it light: nothing moves without a tap.

Source: Team 317 interviews (n=20, Sept 2026)

Verdict

- **Every option they use today is solo**
- **Worth a minute a week for a group trip**
- **Riskiest claim: friends will save together**
- **Pricing untested: 3 pushed back on subscriptions**

Can we make it?

1. Technical: yes

Can the tech do it?

→ **Standard app features; accounts at an FDIC-insured bank.**

2. Operational: yes

Can we run it every week?

habitica

→ **Habitica already runs group challenges on self-reported progress.**

3. Financials: not yet

Does revenue cover the costs?

→ **Freemium + bank referral fees, both still untested.**

Sources: Duolingo Q2 2026 shareholder letter · Superads, Facebook ads install costs for US finance apps · Liftoff 2026 Finance App Benchmark · habitica.com · Team 317 interviews (n=20)

The math

- **Fastest-growing cost: recruiting squads**
- **About $33 per squad (~$8.3 per user)**
- **Each squad brings several new users**
- **Benchmark: ~9% of Duolingo's monthly users pay**

duolingo

- **Verdict: buildable, but revenue is unproven**

Risk

1. Trust and security

How do we earn trust with people's money?

→ FDIC-insured partner bank; nothing moves without a tap.

2. Social pressure

Could squads make people overspend to keep up?

→ Score consistency, not amounts; amounts can be hidden.

3. Novelty wears off

Do streaks still work after month three?

→ Rotate challenges and leagues; test retention in a pilot.

Next steps

- **Start small: students and early-career earners**
- **Pilot with friend groups from interviews**
- **Partner with a banking provider for accounts**
- **Measure weekly saves and squad retention**

Why it works

People will buy it because...

friend groups planning a trip have no tool for saving together;

→ every option they use today is solo.

We can make it because...

the features are standard and a partner bank holds the money;

→ every squad brings its own new users.

It's worth doing because...

young people want to save; they just lack a system.

→ 54% of Gen Z would save an extra $300 a month (BofA).

Source: Bank of America, 2026 Gen Z & The Cost of Adulting (Ipsos, n=1,133 Gen Z adults, Feb 2026)

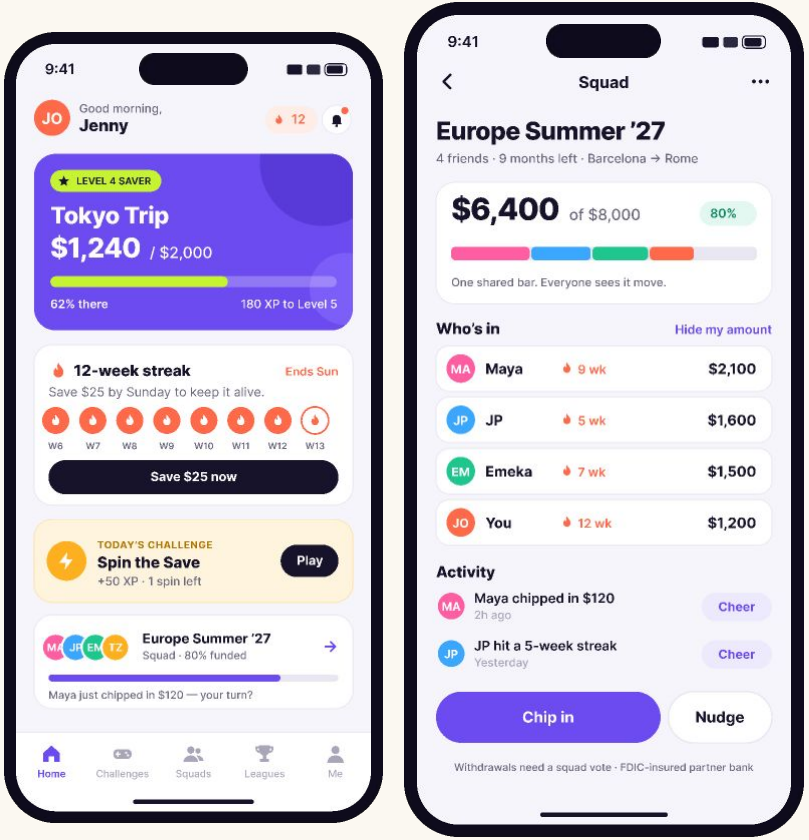
Our wedge

- **Who: friend groups on one campus**
- **When: planning a trip in the next few months**
- **First: squad goal, shared bar and streaks**
- **Later: leagues, duels, solo goals, all 18–30s**

Thank you

Team 317

SaveSquad: save solo, win together.



What we heard

15-question guide · plus BofA 2026 Gen Z study and TIAA-GFLEC index

9 of 20 — **named income or cost of living as their #1 blocker.**
"The more I earn, the more I save."

7 of 20 — **save whatever is left over, or have no set goal.**
Only 21% of 18–29s save a fixed % (BofA).

7 of 20 — **asked for visual progress or radical simplicity.**
An old tool felt "like filing your taxes again."

1 of 5 — **was the lowest score an auto-invest tool got.**
"I just like to have full control."

Sources: Team 317 interviews (n=20, Sept 2026) · BofA Gen Z study (2026) · TIAA-GFLEC Personal Finance Index (2026)

Team 317 · Maker Day 2

20

interviews

Undergrads, MBA and grad students, part-time and full-time workers.

Two tensions

- **Knowing vs. doing**
  Everyone knows they should save.
- **Help vs. control**
  Make it automatic, but let me decide.